



LME KNITTING PATTERN

🇳🇴 RO BUCKET HAT 🇳🇴

WHITE WITH BLUE RO, FLAG AND WAVES

A summer hat in white cotton with the Norwegian flag and "RO" in blue on the front, and two blue splashy waves at the back. The brim is solid blue with a wavy edge. The motifs are knitted right in with colourwork, not embroidered on. The brim ripples like little splashes at the shoreline. The pattern fits child, woman and man.

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TIP: Read the whole pattern through once before you start, and knit a little gauge swatch first. Then the hat comes out exactly the right size.

BEFORE YOU START

This hat is knitted round and round on a circular needle, from the bottom up. You begin with the wavy blue brim, and carry on up in white. On the middle of the main part you knit in "RO" and the flag on the front and the waves on the back, in blue with colourwork, that is right into the hat while you knit. Right at the end you decrease the top together.

WHAT YOU LEARN

- To knit in the round on a circular needle
- To make a wavy edge (it is almost magically easy)
- To knit an even brim in one colour
- To knit in a pattern with two colours (colourwork with floats)
- To decrease stitches so the top turns out nice and round

HOW HARD IS IT?

A little practised. You should be able to cast on stitches, knit in the round and knit two stitches together, and want to try two colours at once. Colourwork is new to many, but we take it step by step. The flag with three colours is the hardest, so take it easy and feel free to ask a grown-up for help there.

HOW TO READ THE NUMBERS

The pattern has three sizes. The numbers are always written like this:

child (woman) man → for example 84 (91) 98 stitches

Knitting the child size, you use the first number. Woman uses the number in brackets, and man uses the last. Tip: Circle your numbers with a pencil before you start.

One step at a time, and it becomes a hat in the end.

WHAT YOU NEED

YARN

DROPS Paris (100% cotton, 50 g = approx. 75 m). A thick, soft cotton yarn knitted on 5 mm needles, just right for this hat.

Colour	Child	Woman	Man
White/natural (main colour)	2 balls	3 balls	3 balls
Royal blue (brim, RO, waves)	2 balls	2 balls	2 balls
Red (for the flag)	1 ball	1 ball	1 ball
Navy blue (for the flag)	scrap	scrap	scrap

You can also use another cotton yarn where the label says 4.5 to 5 mm needles, for example Hobbii Rainbow Cotton 8/8. Always check your gauge!

NEEDLES AND KIT

- A **5 mm circular needle**, 40 cm long (the whole hat is knitted on this)
- **5 mm double-pointed needles** for the top, when it gets too tight on the circular needle
- A 4.5 mm circular needle if you knit loosely (the gauge swatch will tell you)
- A **stitch marker** (or a little loop of yarn in another colour)
- A **tapestry needle with a blunt tip** for weaving in ends
- A little **grid paper and pencil** is smart, so you can draw in the pattern band before you knit
- A tape measure and scissors

GAUGE, THE SECRET KEY

17 stitches and 22 rows of stockinette on 5 mm needles should measure 10 × 10 cm.

How to check: Cast on 22 stitches and knit stockinette (back and forth: one row knit, one row purl) until the swatch is about 12 cm tall. Lay the swatch flat and measure how many stitches there are over 10 cm in the middle.

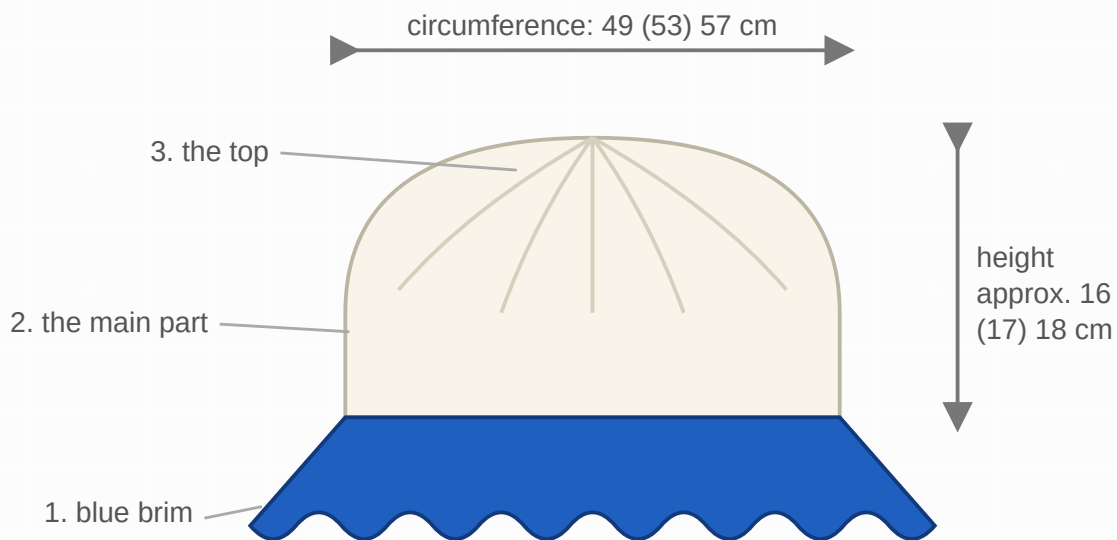
- More than 17 stitches? Switch to a thicker needle (5.5 mm).
- Fewer than 17 stitches? Switch to a thinner needle (4.5 mm).
- Exactly 17 stitches? Perfect, get going!

SIZES AND MEASUREMENTS

WHICH SIZE?

Measure around the head with a tape measure, just above the ears and eyebrows. Choose the size that fits the head measurement. The hat should be 3 to 4 cm smaller than the head, because knitting stretches.

	Child	Woman	Man
Fits head size	50–53 cm	54–57 cm	58–61 cm
Circumference of the hat	approx. 49 cm	approx. 53 cm	approx. 57 cm
Height (without brim)	approx. 16 cm	approx. 17 cm	approx. 18 cm
Stitches in the main part	84	91	98



The numbers go like this: child (woman) man

Not sure about the size? Choose the biggest, a bucket hat looks good sitting a little loose.

GLOSSARY

Term	Means
st	stitch
round	one whole lap around the hat
k	knit, ordinary knit stitches
k2tog	put the needle through two stitches at once and knit them as one. That makes one stitch fewer.
cast on	make the first stitches on the needle
decrease	make the number of stitches smaller, so the hat gets narrower
stockinette in the round	when you knit in the round and knit every round, it comes out smooth and neat. Easier than knitting a hat back and forth!
colourwork	knitting with two colours on the same round, so a pattern comes right into the knitting
float	the thread in the colour you are not using right now, which hangs loosely at the back inside

HOW THE HAT IS BUILT UP

- 1 The blue brim:** You cast on twice as many stitches as you need and knit in blue. When you afterwards knit two stitches together, the edge folds into soft waves all on its own.
- 2 The main part with pattern:** You switch to white, and knit in "RO" and the flag on the front and the waves on the back, all in blue. Around the motifs you knit white.
- 3 The top:** You decrease evenly at seven places, so the top turns out round like a bowl.

PART 1: THE BRIM WITH WAVES

Now we begin! Remember: child (woman) man. The whole brim is knitted in knit, that is stockinette in the round.

- 1 Cast on **168 (182) 196 st** in **blue** on a 5 mm circular needle. Yes, that is a lot of stitches, but it is double on purpose: that is what makes the waves in the end.
- 2 Put the stitch marker on the needle. It shows where the round starts, and it ends up at the centre back of the hat.
- 3 Lay the knitting on the table and check that the cast-on edge is not twisted around the needle. All the stitches should point the same way, like a straight railway track. Then knit the first stitch, now the ring is closed!
- 4 Knit **13 rounds in blue**. The whole brim is blue, without stripes.
- 5 **The wave round (in blue):** Knit k2tog all the way round. Now you have **84 (91) 98 st**, and the brim curves out into lovely waves.
- 6 Switch to **white** (the main colour). Now you knit the rest of the hat in white. Feel free to cut off the blue.

Dropped a stitch? Take it easy. Slide the needle back in and lift it up, or ask a grown-up for help. Nothing is ruined.

CHECKPOINT

- Do you have 84 (91) 98 stitches on the needle?
- Is the whole brim blue?
- Is the edge rippling, and have you switched to white? Then you are ready for part 2!

HOW TO KNIT IN THE PATTERN

Colourwork means you use two colours on the same round. You knit with white where the chart is white (the background colour), and with blue (or red) where the chart shows it. The colour you are not using, you let hang loosely inside. The charts are on pages 9 and 10.

THE THREE THINGS YOU NEED TO KNOW

1

front



Knit each stitch in the colour the chart shows. White is the background, blue is the pattern.

2

back



The colour you are not knitting with hangs loosely at the back. That is called a float. Keep it loose, not tight!

3

long floats



If there are more than 5 stitches between the colours, catch the long float under a stitch along the way. Then it will not hang loose.

GOOD ADVICE

- Keep the floats loose. If you pull them tight, the hat bulges inward and the pattern hides. Better too loose than too tight.
- Read each row of the chart from **right to left**, from the bottom up. Then the letters come out the right way.
- Hold white on one finger and blue on another, or put one down and pick up the other. Both ways work, choose whichever is easiest for you.
- Knit a little gauge swatch in two colours first if you like, then the hat is much easier.

Float = the thread that lies behind. Loose float = lovely pattern.

PART 2: THE MAIN PART WITH PATTERN

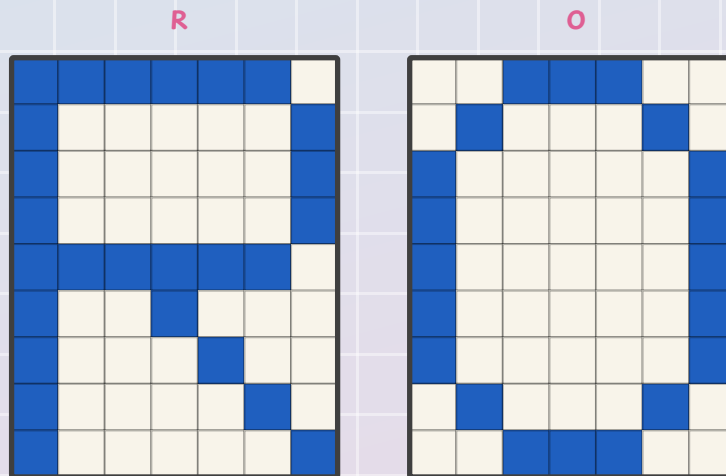
- 1 Carry on in white and knit round until the main part measures **about 3 cm** from the wave round.
- 2 Now you knit in the motifs in blue: **RO on the front** (page 9) and the two **waves on the back** (page 10). Start RO and the waves on the same round, at the bottom. RO is 9 rounds tall, the waves 8.
- 3 When RO is done, you knit the **flag** a little above RO, in the middle (page 9). The flag is in red, white and blue.
- 4 Cut off the colours you no longer use, leaving about 5 cm hanging inside.
- 5 Carry on in white alone, knitting round, until the main part measures **9 (10) 11 cm** from the wave round.

Always count the stitches before you start the pattern band. Getting the placement right is half the job!

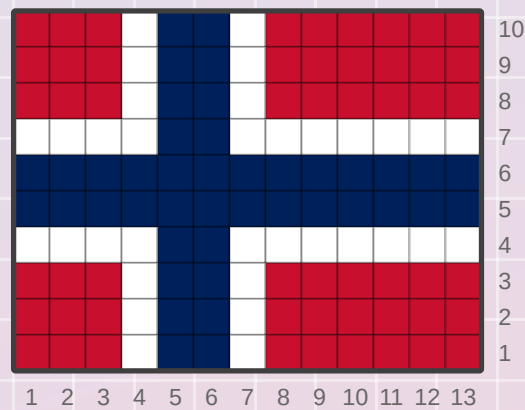
CHART: RO AND THE FLAG (FRONT)

One square = one stitch. Blue square = knit with blue. White square = knit with white (the background colour). On the front, RO sits at the bottom, with the Norwegian flag a little above. Read each row from the bottom up, and from right to left.

RO (EACH LETTER 7 SQUARES WIDE, 9 SQUARES TALL)



THE FLAG (13 squares wide, 10 squares tall)



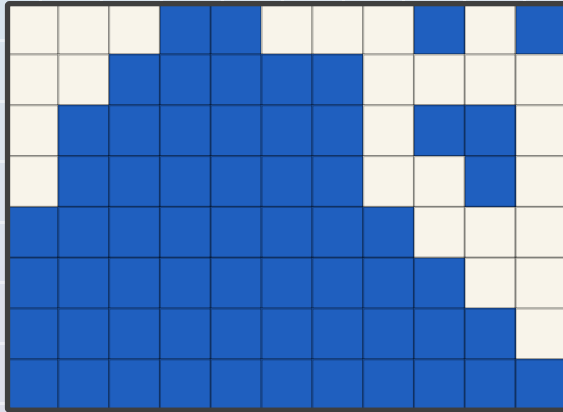
WHERE ON THE HAT?

- **Across:** The centre front is right opposite the stitch marker (which is at the centre back). RO is 15 stitches wide (R, 1 white stitch between, O). Count 7 to 8 stitches to each side of the centre front.
- **Upward:** Knit RO at the bottom, about 8 rounds up from the wave round. Knit the flag about 2 rounds above RO, in the middle.
- Around RO and the flag you knit white. The flag is in red, white and blue.

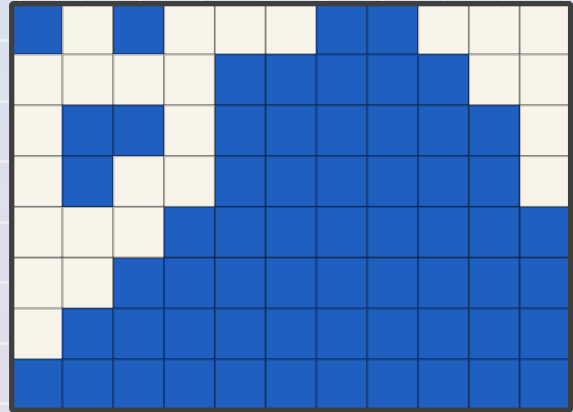
CHART: THE WAVES (BACK)

On the back of the hat you knit two blue splashy waves, one on each side of the centre back. Read each row from the bottom up, and from right to left.

WAVE LEFT (11 x 8)



WAVE RIGHT (mirrored)



WHERE ON THE HAT?

- **Across:** The centre back is at the stitch marker. Place one wave on each side of the marker, with a little white between.
- **Upward:** The waves start on the same round as RO on the front, about 8 rounds up from the wave round.
- The little dots at the top of the chart are sea spray. Do not forget them, they are the finishing touch!

PART 3: THE TOP

The motifs are done and you knit with white alone again. Now the hat gets narrower and narrower, until it closes at the top. You decrease at seven places on each decrease round. After decrease rounds 1, 2, 3 and 4 you knit a plain round without decreasing. From decrease round 5 you decrease on every round.

Decrease round	Child (84 st)	Woman (91 st)	Man (98 st)
1	*k10, k2tog* = 77 st	*k11, k2tog* = 84 st	*k12, k2tog* = 91 st
2	*k9, k2tog* = 70 st	*k10, k2tog* = 77 st	*k11, k2tog* = 84 st
3	*k8, k2tog* = 63 st	*k9, k2tog* = 70 st	*k10, k2tog* = 77 st
etc.	knit one stitch fewer between the decreases each decrease round		
2nd last	*k1, k2tog* the whole round = 14 st		
last	k2tog the whole round = 7 st		

The stars mean: Repeat what is between them, all the way round. When it gets too tight on the circular needle, split the stitches over three or four double-pointed needles and keep knitting exactly as before.

- 1 Cut the yarn, but leave about 30 cm.
- 2 Thread the end onto the tapestry needle and pass it through the last 7 stitches as you lift them off the needle.
- 3 Pull tight so the hole closes, and fasten the thread well inside. The hat itself is done!

FINISHING AND CARE

RIGHT AT THE END

- 1 Weave in all loose ends on the inside of the hat: Work them back and forth through the back of the stitches with the tapestry needle, and trim what is left.
- 2 Look over the floats on the inside. If any are too tight, ease them a little looser with the needle so the pattern on the outside comes out even.
- 3 Rinse the hat in lukewarm water, or wash it at 40 degrees in the machine (cotton takes it just fine).
- 4 Gently squeeze out the water with a towel. Do not wring! Lay the hat flat to dry, and shape the brim into lovely waves while it is wet. However it dries, that is how it stays.

CHECKLIST FOR A FINISHED HAT

- All ends are woven in and the floats lie loosely inside
- "RO" and the flag sit on the front, the waves on the back
- The brim ripples and the top is round
- The hat is dry and ready for summer, sea and soft ice cream

Congratulations, you have knitted your very own RO hat!
Show it off on the 17th of May, at the cabin and in the boat.



Happy summer!

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